

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Call Centres: Are You Talking To AI? (V2)

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

Part 1: Note Completion - NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS

No.	Sentence
1	When a customer is finally connected, the worker is described as a _____ rather than a machine.
2	The call-centre industry is economically _____ in countries such as India and the Philippines.
3	A customer may already be aggravated and keep on _____.
4	The worker must _____ the client.
5	The worker must _____.
6	At the same time, AI _____ of workers' conversations creates additional pressure.
7	Some workers believe that AI may replace them in the _____.
8	One study estimated that approximately _____ could be displaced.
9	The speaker believes that these gradual _____ have already begun.
10	AI may not completely replace human workers because it lacks _____.

11 **Why is the increasing use of AI in call centres a wider concern in countries such as India and the Philippines?**

- A Call-centre companies there rely mainly on overseas technology.
- B Call-centre employment represents an important part of their economies.
- C Workers there have received insufficient training in artificial intelligence.
- D Customers there are unwilling to communicate with automated systems.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 12 **Which situation does the call-centre worker describe as particularly difficult?**
- A Recording personal information from impatient customers
 - B Persuading customers to accept an automated solution
 - C Correcting the AI system while continuing the conversation
 - D Calming an angry customer while dealing with the complaint
- 13 **What additional pressure does the worker experience during a difficult call?**
- A Her performance is being monitored by an AI system.
 - B She may be replaced immediately after the call ends.
 - C She is expected to train the robot speaking to the customer.
 - D She is prevented from resolving the customer's concern herself.
- 14 **Why may AI monitoring make an already stressful call more difficult?**
- A It requires workers to use unfamiliar technical language.
 - B It causes customers to become more aggressive towards workers.
 - C It evaluates workers while they are handling a demanding situation.
 - D It makes workers responsible for repairing failures in the AI system.
- 15 **What contrast is presented regarding the role of AI in call centres?**
- A AI understands customers well but performs administrative work poorly.
 - B AI is intended to assist workers but may eventually replace them.
 - C AI reduces the number of complaints but increases waiting times.
 - D AI protects existing jobs but makes interactions more stressful.
- 16 **How does the worker view the displacement of call-centre employees?**
- A It is a near-term process that has already begun gradually.
 - B It is a distant possibility for which there is currently no evidence.
 - C It is a temporary development affecting only senior employees.
 - D It is a completed transition that has affected most workers already.
- 17 **Why does the worker believe AI cannot fully replace human call-centre staff?**
- A AI cannot monitor several conversations at the same time.
 - B AI is unable to understand the factual details of complaints.
 - C AI cannot provide customers with solutions quickly enough.
 - D AI lacks the empathy and compassion shown by human beings.

- 18 **Why does the speaker refer to the study predicting the displacement of 300,000 workers?**
- A To explain how the call-centre industry originally developed
 - B To prove that every call-centre employee will lose their job
 - C To support her concern with specific numerical evidence
 - D To compare employment levels in different countries
- 19 **What is illustrated by the comparison between speaking to a person and speaking to a robot?**
- A Human workers are generally more technically accurate.
 - B Human interaction provides a greater sense of compassion.
 - C Customers behave more politely when AI monitors the call.
 - D Robots can understand emotions but cannot express them.
- 20 **What is the overall implication of the discussion?**
- A AI will mainly improve waiting times and make call-centre employment more secure.
 - B The economic effects of AI will remain limited to the Philippines.
 - C Human staff will become unnecessary once AI monitoring improves.
 - D AI may displace workers, but its emotional limitations make full replacement uncertain.